

# Agent Book Public Workflow Toy Book

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# Preface

This tiny book is fake on purpose. It exists to show how manuscript text, externalized chunks, clean data, citations, maps, and agent instructions fit together.



# Chapter 1

## Umbrellas and the damp notebook problem

This toy chapter studies an imaginary civic problem: towns keep too many notebooks near too many puddles. The average town-year in the fake data has 34 umbrellas, and the most umbrella-heavy town-year is Soggy Ledger in 2025.

The point is not the umbrellas. The point is that prose can use values created in an externalized hidden chunk. An agent can update `analysis/ch01/chunks/umbrella-inline-stats.R`, render the book, and check whether this sentence still works.

Fig. 1.1 is deliberately simple. It gives the public template a real figure with a stable chunk label and a generated map entry.

Table 1.1 is built from an externalized table chunk. The same pattern works for serious tables: keep the caption and label stable, move the code out of the chapter, and let the agent work on the narrow file.

This fake example cites both an author-managed source (A. Example 1901) and an agent-added source (H. Agent 2026).

Table 1.1: Toy umbrella summary by town.

| Town          | Avg. puddles | Avg. umbrellas | Avg. notebooks | Avg. cocoa cups |
|---------------|--------------|----------------|----------------|-----------------|
| Buttonwick    | 6.5          | 16.5           | 4.0            | 23.0            |
| Lint Harbor   | 8.0          | 23.0           | 5.0            | 35.0            |
| Mildly Damp   | 14.5         | 35.5           | 9.0            | 48.0            |
| North Brisket | 15.0         | 35.0           | 7.5            | 47.5            |
| Soggy Ledger  | 22.0         | 50.0           | 11.5           | 65.0            |
| Velvet Drain  | 19.5         | 44.0           | 10.0           | 60.5            |

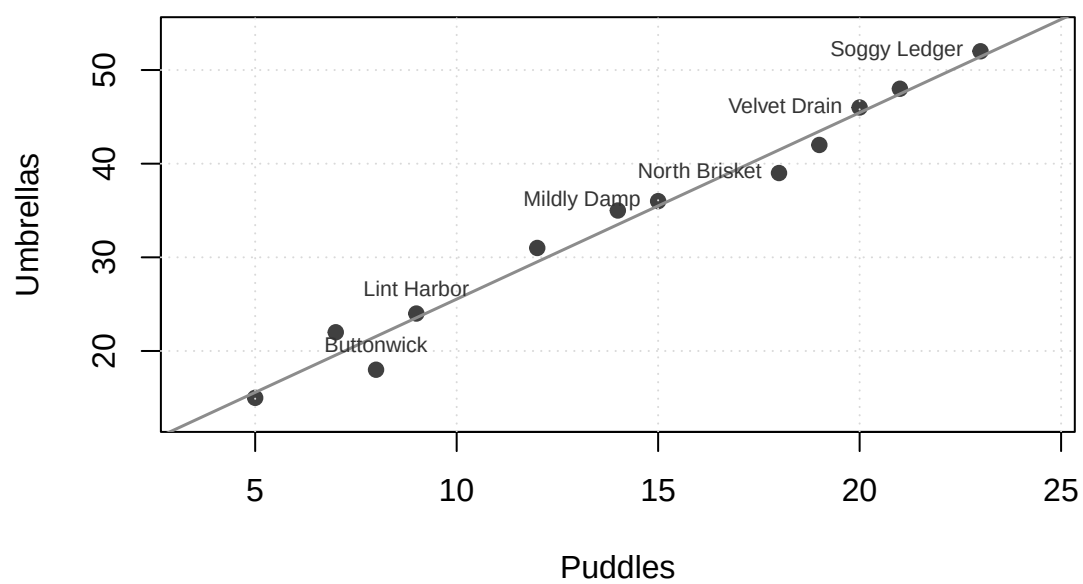


Figure 1.1: Toy towns with more puddles tend to report more umbrellas. Town names mark the 2025 observations.



## Chapter 2

# The committee for dry socks

The second toy chapter is here to show chapter ordering. Bookdown uses `_bookdown.yml`, while the source files use prefixes like 01-, 02-, and 03- so humans and agents can keep the order straight.

The committee in this chapter has three rules:

- never store notebooks under a leaky ceiling
- never trust a spreadsheet without row counts
- never ask an agent to make every row match

The last rule matters. A better prompt is: merge accurately, report unmatched rows, and explain whether any defensible corrections are available.

For citations, this chapter points to another toy source (B. Example 1902).



## Chapter 3

# A tiny methods appendix wearing a raincoat

This chapter explains the method for producing replicable datasets as part of an article, book, or dissertation.

Raw data live under `data_construction/data/raw/`. The cleaning script writes clean data to `data_construction/data/clean/`. The render script copies the clean data into `book/data/` and then into the Bookdown render wrapper.

The agent instructions are part of the method. They tell agents where to look, what not to touch, and how to report uncertainty. The result is not magic. It is a project layout that makes careful work easier to ask for and easier to review.

The map idea is also part of the method (C. Agent 2026). Rendered figure and table numbers can change. Chunk labels and source files are more stable.



# Citations

Agent, Careful. 2026. “Small Maps for Finding Figures and Tables.”

Agent, Helpful. 2026. “A Tiny Demonstration of Externalized Chunks.”

Example, Ada. 1901. *Sensible Notes on Damp Sidewalks*. Public Template Press.

Example, Bruno. 1902. “Notebooks Before Breakfast.” *Journal of Toy Methods* 1 (1): 1–9.